

Clockwise from left: Hussain Shahzad, Executive Chef-Hunger Inc. Hospitality; Sourdough bread; Loaves from Tartine Bakery, San Francisco; Garlic cheese roll at Veronica's, Bandra



Sourdough bread is made with a naturally fermented starter instead of commercial yeast. This gives it a distinctive, slightly sour flavor and a heartier texture.



Rising to the occasion

Chefs are now bringing new, delicious approaches to breadmaking. At Taupe By Titlie, a modern Indian restaurant in Goa, co-founder and chef Tarun Sibal pairs a dal kurchan with a biscuit bread and dal makhni with an assortment of kulchas studded with chorizo, sundried tomatoes and parmesan. One of the most popular items on the menu at Khi Khi Delhi (also by Sibal) are the kaladi cheese olive oil bread, reminiscent of the 'bread pizzas' we loved from the neighbourhood bakery.

Chef Shahzad too has been pushing a lot of boundaries with his breads at Veronica's the all-day sandwich shop by the folks behind Bombay Canteen. Take the tiger bread used in the hearty mushroom sandwich. Along with memorable flavour, it crackles just the right amount before giving way to a springy, soft interior. The incredibly fluffy and soft Hokkaido milk bun shoulders the robust Smash Burger. But if you are looking for the most opulent loaf it's The Gold Leaf Bread by the family-owned Pan Pina Bakery in Algatocn, Andalusia, Spain. Master baker Moreno uses 250 mg of gold dust in the bread that is priced at $120.73 (over ₹10,000 a loaf). Move over caviar, there's a new indulgence in town!